

■ By Shankkar Aiyar

Every inch of India is ruled by the states and the Centre as famously described by N.T. Rama Rao "is a conceptual myth". And how well are the states ruled? The quick cynical response would be, poorly. The India Story of 9 per cent GDP growth notwithstanding, large tracts of the country reflect apathy. The worst five states, which account for 373 million or a third of the 1,100 million population, do not score more than 1.5 on a scale of 10 in six of the eight parameters. It is no secret that two-thirds of India is dependent on the rural economy and 55 per cent of the

BIG STATES

RANK 2008		2008*	2007	2006	2005	2004
1	PUNJAB	3.16	1	1	1	1
2	TAMIL NADU	2.79	4	4	4	4
3	HIMACHAL PRADESH	2.74	3	3	3	3
4	KERALA	2.66	2	2	2	2
5	GUJARAT	2.38	5	7	7	7
6	HARYANA	2.38	8	5	5	5
7	KARNATAKA	2.31	7	8	8	8
8	MAHARASHTRA	2.27	6	6	6	6
9	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.03	10	10	11	11
10	UTTARAKHAND	1.91	9	9	9	9
11	JAMMU & KASHMIR	1.90	11	11	10	10
12	RAJASTHAN	1.59	12	12	12	13
13	ASSAM	1.48	14	16	16	15
14	MADHYA PRADESH	1.48	13	14	14	12
15	WEST BENGAL	1.42	15	13	13	14
16	CHHATTISGARH	1.23	16	15	15	16
17	ORISSA	1.13	18	18	18	18
18	UTTAR PRADESH	1.11	17	17	17	17
19	JHARKHAND	0.98	19	19	19	19
20	BIHAR	0.74	20	20	20	20

Big states are those with an area of over 35,000 sq km and over 5 million population. * Figures are 2008 scores (out of 10) on states' and UTs' overall performance based on agriculture, primary health, primary education, law and order, infrastructure, investment, consumer markets and macro economy.

SMALL STATES

RANK 2008		2008*	2007	2006	2005	2004
1	MIZORAM	4.78	5	5	4	3
2	DELHI	3.94	3	3	2	2
3	PUDUCHERRY	3.77	1	1	3	1
4	GOA	3.65	2	2	1	4
5	SIKKIM	2.23	4	4	5	5
6	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	1.85	7	8	6	6
7	NAGALAND	1.73	6	6	8	7
8	MANIPUR	1.62	9	7	7	8
9	TRIPURA	1.50	8	9	9	9
10	MEGHALAYA	1.46	10	10	10	10

Small states are those with area of less than 35,000 sq km and population below 5 million



ASSAM IS THE FASTEST MOVER

Demographic dividend, better fiscal management, investments and some respite from militancy have helped the state lifting it from number 15 to number 11 since 2003.

UNION TERRITORIES

RANK 2008		2008*	2007	2006	2005	2004
1	CHANDIGARH	3.84	1	1	1	1
2	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	2.53	2	2	2	3
3	DAMAN & DIU	2.21	4	3	3	4
4	LAKSHADWEEP	2.08	3	5	4	2
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	1.71	5	4	5	5